have around 100 computers using Squid as the proxy server, you need to enter a range of IPs. Let's look at two scenarios:

First, two computers (X and Y) using Squid, with IPs ***192.168.0.2*** and ***192.168.0.3*** respectively. By adding the lines ***'acl X src 192.168.0.2'*** and ***'acl Y src 192.168.0.3'***, you permit only these two computers to access the Internet through Squid.

In the second example, we allow all IPs between ***192.168.0.2*** and ***192.168.0.254*** to access Squid. To do this, you need to add the following line: ***'acl 'entire_office' src 192.168.0.2-192.168.0.254/255.255.255.0'***. This tells Squid to allow the user group ***'entire_office'*** to access the Internet—you can replace ***'entire_office'*** with anything you want.

The next section is 'http_access'. Here, be careful to allow access to any group you've added an acl line for. So for the examples mentioned above, make sure you add 'allow' lines above the ***'http_access deny all'*** line. You'll see a line that says ***INSERT YOUR OWN RULE(s) HERE TO ALLOW ACCESS FROM YOUR CLIENTS***. Add the lines here.

For the first example, add: ***'http_access allow X'*** and ***'http_access allow Y'***.

For the second example, where we allowed access to the 'entire_office' group, add the line: ***'http_access allow entire_office'***. Now, uncomment the ***'http_access deny all'*** line, making sure that it's below the allow lines you just added, and your permissions are all set.

The final step is to find the ***visible_hostname*** line, uncomment it and add a hostname. Usually, this is the machine name.

Am I finally done?

Yes! All you need to do now is go to the ***/usr/local/squid/sbin*** folder, using ***cd /usr/local/squid/sbin*** and type ***./squid*** to start Squid. Use another computer's browser to connect to Squid and test it *(See box 'Setting up the Clients' for details)*. Use the ***./squid -k parse*** command to check for errors in your squid.conf file. Try the ***./squid -h*** command for help.

That's all there is to Squid?

Unfortunately, no! We've shown you how to set up a very simple HTTP proxy—it's secure, but in no way makes use of anything even remotely close to Squid's capabilities. There are hundreds of different possible configurations, and each has its own benefits. We suggest you spend some time reading up on Squid. *Squid*, *The Definitive Guide*, by Duane Wessels, published by O'Reilly books ***(www.oreilly.com)***, extensively covers this subject. If we were to list out every feature that Squid offers, this issue would have been tagged the 'Digit-Squid special'!

You can also set up Squid to act as a proxy server for HTTPS and FTP access, and not just HTTP. Of course, you need to use the respective switches with the ***./configure*** command right at the beginning. Apart from being a proxy server, Squid can also throttle bandwidth, making sure no client gets an unfair share. You can also configure Squid to allow certain users access between certain times, or only on certain days of the week, etc—the possibilities are endless.

Finally, we suggest you download its configuration manual from ***http://squid.visolve.com/squid/squid24s1/sq24.tar.gz*** to get a better idea of what this ingenious little software is capable of. Here's hoping we'll see you Squidding down the Internet soon!

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